



**Resolution
Project**

**Virtual Social Venture Challenge
Competitor Information**

About Resolution Project

Founded in 2007, Resolution Project (“Resolution”) is a unique pathway to action for aspiring young leaders committed to changing the world today. Resolution identifies and empowers undergraduate students across the globe who wish to launch new social ventures, supported by Resolution’s international network of resources. The Resolution Fellowship comes with seed-funding, mentorship, and access to a wide community of leaders!

Model

Resolution has a proven model for identifying and empowering young leaders through our Social Venture Challenge (“SVC”) and Resolution Fellowship:

- We collaborate with existing youth conferences, universities, non-profits.
- We invite undergraduate students to propose social ventures through our SVC—a multi-stage competition, combining web-based submissions, live rounds of presentations, and due diligence.
- We award Resolution Fellowships to those young leaders with the most compelling personal leadership characteristics and promising social venture proposals.
- We support Fellows by providing an ecosystem of dynamic, hands-on mentorship, seed funding, and access to world-class global advisory resources from our dedicated team of volunteers and mentors.

Forum Expectations:



The SVC Forum is an opportunity for your team to share important information about your venture to several judges. Please prepare a brief pitch deck to present. You should create a PowerPoint, PDF, or Google Slide presentation for this pitch. You will only have 5 minutes for your pitch so we recommend you practice your pitch in advance. Following your pitch, judges will take 5 minutes to ask questions about your venture.



You will present yourself, your connection to the issue area, and finally your proposed venture.

Pictured here are some examples from past in-person Forums. You can also view videos of past Forums online at youtube.com/@ResolutionProject



Finals Expectations:



The SVC Finals is a formal pitch opportunity where teams will get 5 minutes to pitch their venture to a panel of judges. We will then allot 10 minutes for question and answer. We recommend you practice this pitch in advance. You should create a PowerPoint, PDF, or Google Slide presentation for this pitch.

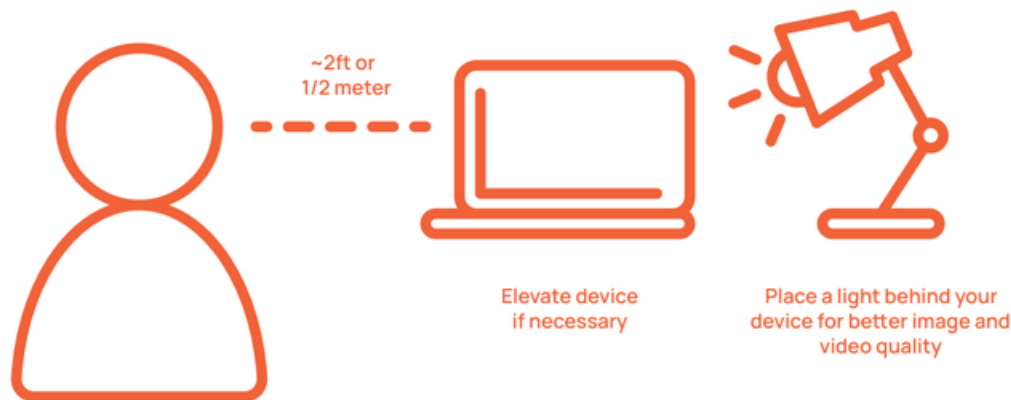


Pictured here are some examples from past in-person Finals. You can also view videos of past Finals online at youtube.com/@ResolutionProject



Setting-up Your Presentation Station!

- Check your internet connection before the competition and have a back-up internet capable device if possible!
- Make sure that your camera is just above eye-level. Use a small box or other item to elevate your computer.
- Make sure to light yourself! Placing a light behind your computer (2-3ft away) facing yourself improves your video quality!
- Join from a quiet location and use an external microphone if possible! Audio and visual distractions in the background of your video can make it difficult for judges to stay focused on your pitch. Using headphones with a microphone will help reduce audio distractions as well!



- Make sure to practice with your setup and technology before the competition! Set up a call with a friend and practice your pitch!
- You should be centered in the frame about 2ft (1/2 Meter) from your camera with a neutral background

During Your Pitch

- Leave your microphone on MUTE unless you are the current presenter!
- Leave your webcam OFF if you are NOT the current presenter!
- Speak slowly and clearly! Audio over the internet can easily become distorted, remember this!
- When answering judges' questions, briefly pause between responses. This will allow judges more opportunities to ask important clarifying questions.
- Make eye contact with your camera lens! This will help your judges stay engaged throughout your pitch!

I Lost Connection to the Call, What Now?!

If you are suddenly disconnected from the call, do not worry! You will be allowed to finish your pitch! Try to rejoin the call as soon as possible.

To Rejoin:

- Restart the video conferencing application and try to rejoin the call using the same Zoom link.
- If you cannot rejoin after restarting, try to use a backup device to join (if you can only join by phone/audio that is okay, but video is preferred!)
- If you still cannot join, please email (meredith@resolutionproject.org) or WhatsApp message (+1 832 381 0458) Meredith (she/her). If you are a US based team, you can call or text that same number. The Fellow Recruitment Associate will monitoring their inbox to assist you with connectivity issues.
- If you cannot get into contact with the Fellow Recruitment Associate and cannot rejoin the call, we will do our best to have you present to our judges—though this may not be immediate and may be outside the original times of the competition previously shared with you. Resolution Project will message you immediately to schedule a follow-up presentation.

What to Focus on for both Forum & Finals

- **Budget**

- You should have at least one slide on your presentation (or a separate pdf) that includes a budget slide.
- This only needs to be a simple line-item budget with items, expenses, and the frequency of those expenses.

- **Define Beneficiaries**

- Know who your specific demographic is. Who are you intending to work with first? Be as specific with your initial beneficiary group as possible.
- i.e. helping to end "all hunger" in an area is not specific enough, tell me the specific people or group of people your venture will begin its outreach with.

- **Impact Evaluation**

- What is your measurement technique for knowing that you are making the impact you want to make? It is not enough to say "I want to make X impact", you must be ready to demonstrate that you can make that impact measurable.

- **Major Goals**

- Be prepared to discuss your goals in terms of the next 6 months, 1 year, and two years. Note, that these goals should be about your venture's progress, not the issue area itself.

What to Focus on for both Forum & Finals continued

- **Community Outreach and Sustainability**

- Financial. Resolution only offers one-time funding for our grants. So please ensure that you are prepared to speak about what additional sources of funding you are considering in order to sustain your venture over the long term once you have exhausted the Resolution grant.
 - If you are a for-profit company, when do you start making money? If you are a non-profit, what other income streams are you hoping to identify and secure in the future?
 - Be as specific as possible, although you do not need to have already secured any partnerships.
- Community. How will you ensure that people are continuously engaged with your project? What is your community outreach strategy and how will you be getting key stakeholders in the community on your side?

- **Be bold but reasonable! Start small with a plan to build!**

- It is tempting to want to solve all of the issue immediately, but keep your proposal narrow at launch and provide a framework for growth in the future. Know exactly what you need to get to your launch not what your venture will need in 5 years!

Evaluative Criteria for Social Ventures

Criteria	0 Inadequate	1 Barely Adequate	2 Good	3 Strong
Makes a Difference in the Community	Venture has little or no impact on the community, other than on the Prospective Fellows themselves.	Venture will impact a small number of people beyond the Prospective Fellows.	Venture will be a resource and source of pride for many in the community.	Venture potentially will make major positive impacts in building the community & demonstrating nationally that youth are resources.
Youth Created, Led and Managed	Appears adult led. Youth play supporting roles & do not have substantial responsibility.	Youth lead most aspects of the <u>venture</u> , adults are engaged in some aspects.	Youth lead almost all aspects of the venture. Adults are involved minimally.	Young people lead all aspects of the venture – the creating, planning and execution.
Designed to be a Lasting/ Ongoing Organization	Venture is structured as a one-time project, and is not likely to continue.	Venture has the potential to become ongoing, but plans are vague. The Venture is not structured for the future.	Venture has good potential, a good plan, and is structured to handle future team turnover.	Venture has clear plans to become ongoing, including transition plans & structured roles of responsibility for future team members.
Involves a Strong Team	Venture involves no other youth and does not benefit others from the community.	Venture is a partnership, or involves or benefits a small group in the community.	Venture involves a small group as planners and organizers, and benefits many from the community.	Venture involves a group of youth as planners, a larger body of youth as implementers, and benefits many others.
Clear, Attainable Goals	Venture has no clear goals.	Venture may have some vague goals, but little or no explanation of how they will be reached.	Venture has clear short-term goals, and has not developed longer-term goals.	Venture has clear goals for short term and ultimate long-term goals.
Credible Plan and Budget	Venture has no plans for future sustenance and no budget.	Venture has an outline of a plan and a vague budget.	Venture has a clear plan and budget, though both may need revisions.	Venture has a clear, focused plan and budget outlining how the venture will meet its goals.
Energy and Skills to Succeed	Youth show limited energy and commitment and are missing skills key to the venture's success.	Youth show some energy and commitment, and have some abilities needed to succeed.	Most of the youth have high energy, a high level of commitment, and most of the abilities needed for success.	Youth demonstrate high energy levels, unswerving commitment, and the abilities to make the venture succeed.
Involves an Ally	Venture has no Ally.	Venture has a weak Ally.	Venture has a strong Ally.	Venture has a strong Ally and consistent support.
Ethical Standards	Youth show tendencies to involve in unethical behavior.	Youth understand right from wrong, and guide their actions ethically.	Youth have pride in their strong morals and integrity.	Youth are role models in their community for ethical behavior.

Evaluative Criteria for Founders & Co-founders:

Criteria	0 Inadequate	1 Barely Adequate	2 Good	3 Strong
Integrity and Commitment to Social Responsibility	Prospective Fellow's integrity is ambiguous.	Prospective Fellow shows passion for the venture with uncertain commitment to social responsibility.	Prospective Fellow shows passion for the venture and a commitment to social responsibility.	Prospective Fellow shows moral courage, passion for the venture and long-standing commitment to social responsibility.
Poise and Professionalism	Prospective Fellow is unprofessional or makes poor decisions.	Prospective Fellow does not inspire confidence but is professional and makes reasonable decisions.	Prospective Fellow inspires confidence and makes good decision, but lacks professional polish.	Prospective Fellow inspires confidence, acts professionally, and makes good decisions.
Initiative and Follow-through	Prospective Fellow is motivated by others or driven by more senior individuals.	Prospective Fellow is self-motivated, but has difficulty completing tasks.	Prospective Fellow is self-motivated, but relies on validation from external forces to complete tasks.	Prospective Fellow is self-motivated, and drives process to completion of his/her own accord.
Organization, Preparedness and Management	Prospective Fellow is disorganized and presents poorly.	Prospective Fellow is disorganized or focuses on insignificant matters but presents well.	Prospective Fellow has a clear and well-considered plan but has not considered and prepared himself/herself for complex and nuanced challenges.	Prospective Fellow has taken a complex issue and presented a clear and well-considered plan that positions him/her for success.
Charisma and Inspiring Others	Prospective Fellow is unable to articulate his/her vision and cannot motivate others.	Prospective Fellow has difficulty motivating others by communicating his/her vision.	Prospective Fellow articulates his/her vision well and has developed buy-in from his/her peers.	Prospective Fellow is natural leader who articulates his/her vision well and has developed buy-in from all constituencies.
Teamwork and Collaborative Capacity	Prospective Fellow is unable to effectively work with teammates.	Prospective Fellow has difficulty managing to lead and/or work within a team and is most effective as an individual.	Prospective Fellow collaborates well but doesn't utilize all teammates to their greatest potential.	Prospective Fellow collaborates fluidly and reaches a greater end result through teamwork.
Proven Ability to Benefit from Mentorship	Prospective Fellow becomes defensive when faced with feedback or regresses from one interaction to the next.	Prospective Fellow appreciates feedback but shows little progress and poor synthesis of new ideas from one interaction to the next.	Prospective Fellow appreciates feedback and shows some progress and integrates new ideas from one interaction to the next.	Prospective Fellow is eager for feedback and shows thoughtful integration of new ideas from one interaction to the next.